SPEAKING PART 1

Personal Questions

Task Overview

In Part 1, you will answer three personal questions. The questions are about **familiar**, **everyday topics** (for example: your free time, your home, your routine, or your preferences). You will speak for 30 seconds per question.

Key points:

- There are 3 questions: speak for 30 seconds per question
- The questions are about personal familiar topics
- There is no preparation time

General strategy

- Try to speak for the full **30 seconds** for each question.
- Try to use **longer** sentences, **connecting** your ideas logically.
- Focus on fluency in giving spontaneous answers.
- If you don't know what else to say, try to add extra details: where / when / who / why?
- Practise all the questions you can – they will probably be repeated on the day of the exam!

In this chapter, you will:

- Practise common Part 1 question types
- Learn how to extend short answers into 30-second responses
- Review useful language for **preferences**, **routines**, and **past experiences**
- Do timed practice sets in real exam conditions

Want more Speaking Part 1 practice?
Scan the QR code to access extra practice in exam conditions in the Seif Aptis Trainer.

Task 1: Useful fillers and openers

You won't have a lot of time (only 30 seconds) for each question, but you could make use of these natural openers, especially if you need some time to think about your answer.

1: **Well, let me think...**	4: **I've never given it much thought**
2: **That's an interesting/tricky question.**	5: **It really depends, but...**
3: **I've never really thought about it, but...**	6: **Let me think about that for a second.**

Try using some of these when practising the exam tasks!

Exam Reminder:
We are introducing these phrases here, but can also be used in parts 2 and 3 for the follow-up questions (after describing the photo or photos). But **remember:** our priority is always to answer the question

Task 2: Extending your answer

For some questions, a logical answer can be short and direct — so it's useful to develop some strategies to **extend** your answer for the **full 30 seconds**!
Look at the following example questions, and think of ways to add to the basic answer.

1: What is the weather like today?

A: Today, it's quite cloudy and a little cold.

- Was it different yesterday or earlier today?
- Do you expect it to change?
- Does it affect your plans in any way?
- Do you like this kind of weather?

2: What's your favourite kind of food?

A: It's definitely pizza.

- What kind of pizza do you like best? Which toppings?
- How often do you eat it and where?
- Do you make it yourself?
- Is it healthy? Why / why not?

Exam Tip:
Your answer does not have to be true! You can invent whatever answer you like if it's easier to talk and develop your answer.

Task 3: Avoiding typical mistakes

The following are all examples of **typical mistakes** made in speaking part 1. There is **ONE** mistake in each answer. Can you **correct** it?

In each of the following answers, **circle** the part which is incorrect, and think about why it is wrong: is the **meaning** wrong, or is there a **grammatical** problem?
Try to write a **possible correction** on the line provided.

Q: What's your typical day like?

A: On a typical day, I like doing some exercise before work.

Correct:

_____

Q: What are you wearing today?

A: Today, I wear jeans, a blue tee-shirt and a jumper.

Correct:

_____

Q: What did you do last night?

A: Last night, I have been out dancing with my friends.

Correct:

_____

Q: What do you usually do at the weekend?

A: On Sundays, I use to play football in a local league.

Correct:

_____

Q: Tell me about your work or studies?

A: I'm P.E teacher at a secondary school.

Correct:

_____

Q: What was your favourite subject at school?

A: Maths, because I was always very good in it.

Correct:

_____

Exam Reminder:
This part is only testing up to a **B1 level**, so your answers don't need to be very complicated. Focus on speaking for the **full 30 seconds** and answering the **right question**!

Speaking part 1: exam practice

Now try some complete speaking part 1 tasks.
🚨 Remember: ⏱️ Time 30 seconds per question!

Task 1:

1: Do you do any sports or exercise?

2: What are you wearing today?

3: Do you prefer travelling alone or with other people?

Task 2:

1: Tell me about something you did yesterday.

2: Do you spend more time with family or with friends?

3: What is your favourite time of year?

Task 3:

1: Where did you last go on holiday?

2: What are you going to do this weekend?

3: Tell me about your family.

Task 4:

1: What do you usually have for breakfast?

2: What kind of music do you enjoy listening to?

3: What games did you like playing as a child?

Want to practise more speaking part 1?
Scan the QR code to access the speaking part 1 section of the Seif Aptis Trainer and practise the task in **exam conditions.**